

Build a case that can be checked

Reusable evidence toolkit

Blank forms, narrative structure, evidence intake, record requests, competing hypotheses, corrections and publication review. Adapt each form to actual records.

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Version 1.0 | Source-checked working edition

Prepared with AI-assisted research. Source authority, case relevance and document authenticity must be evaluated separately. This is a research resource, not a certification of facts or a legal filing.

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1 Start here

Create one case identifier. Keep event dates separate from dates when you learned about them. Preserve original files and make separate working or redacted copies. Use only lawful access. The templates do not create legal privilege, protection, admissibility or a finding of wrongdoing.[C03, C06, C22]

The forms below are intentionally blank. They contain no allegation that any specific reader is targeted. Do not import case facts from another person's story into your own statement. A similar pattern is a lead to test.

Suggested folder convention: originals, working copies, redacted public copies, source register, claims, timelines, requests, review and releases. The optional Python manager uses its own documented case-folder structure. Hashes support byte-integrity checks; they do not prove truth or collection authenticity.

2 Evidence intake and file integrity

The local tool copies a supplied file, assigns an exhibit ID, records a SHA-256 digest and adds a custody event. It does not image a device, preserve every filesystem attribute or create an immutable forensic repository. Follow its README before use. For a potentially compromised device, obtain qualified collection advice before changing settings or running tools on it.[C03]

```
python3 scripts/evidence_manager.py init /path/to/CASE-001
python3 scripts/evidence_manager.py add /path/to/CASE-001 \
/path/to/record.pdf --case CASE-001 --title "Original notice" \
--collector "Collector name" --source "Record custodian" \
--access restricted
python3 scripts/evidence_manager.py verify /path/to/CASE-001
```

Keep confidential material out of the public repository. Overleaf receives only material appropriate for that service and its sharing settings; classified material requires an approved channel.[C07, C19]

3 Case opening sheet

Case identifier / neutral short title

Prepared by / version / date / reviewer

Observed problem in one sentence

Relevant place, date range and time zone

What decision, loss, injury or disappearance is at issue?

What outcome or correction is requested?

Who can lawfully access the originals?

Known deadlines and source of each deadline

Confidential identifiers stored separately / reference only

4 Neutral incident narrative

Structure: observation, source, consequence, uncertainty, request.

On [event date/time/time zone], I [directly observed / received / was informed of] [specific event]. The supporting record is [exhibit ID, title, pinpoint]. [Decision or consequence] followed on [date]. I can verify [facts]. I cannot presently verify [mechanism/identity/intent]. [Alternative explanation] remains possible because [reason]. I request [specific existing records, independent review or correction].

What I personally observed

What another person told me, and who/when

What a document states, with exhibit and pinpoint

My inference, identified explicitly as an inference

Evidence that may contradict my account

What would resolve the uncertainty?

5 Claim and predicate worksheet

Claim ID / exact proposition to test

Necessary elements: event, mechanism, actor, intent, authority

Evidence supporting each element / pinpoint

Evidence against each element / pinpoint

Source independence: common origin or independent observation?

Alternative explanation and discriminating evidence

Current status / confidence rationale / review date

Next lawful collection step / owner / target date

6 Timeline entry

Event ID / case ID

Event date, time, zone and precision (exact, approximate, range)

Date recorded / date learned / date retrieved

Neutral event description

Source ID / exhibit ID / page or timestamp

Direct observation, attributed account or inference?

Conflicting dates and why they differ

Related decision or consequence; link supported by what evidence?

Reviewer / status / next check

7 Exhibit and custody record

Exhibit ID / original filename / title

Creator, custodian and originating system

How and when lawfully acquired / time zone

File format, bytes, SHA-256 / tool version

Authenticity indicators and limitations

Transfer: from, to, date, purpose, receipt

Derived copies: conversion/redaction and new hash

Storage location, access class and backup verification

Certification requested from custodian?

8 Source card and independence test

Source ID / author / institution / title / publication date

URL / archive URL / retrieval date / local exhibit ID

Exact page, paragraph, section or timestamp

Which precise claim does this source support?

Primary record, later account, advocacy, analysis or hearsay?

Does it quote another source? Trace to the earliest available record.

What it does not establish / conflicts / correction history

Copyright and public-release basis

9 Connection record

A relationship label must state what is actually supported: employment, contract, communication, payment, access, co-presence, oversight or an attributed allegation. Avoid a generic “connected to” edge.

Edge ID / entity A / entity B / identity disambiguation

Relationship type and direction

Dates active / source and pinpoint

Documented, reported, disputed or hypothetical?

Does this establish opportunity, mechanism or actual action?

Alternative explanation / evidence needed to upgrade or remove edge

Publication review and privacy constraints

10 Competing hypotheses

For each hypothesis list a predicted observation, evidence found, contrary evidence, missing evidence and a lawful discriminating test. Do not count repeated news stories as independent corroboration. **H1: ordinary accident, illness, error or authorized action**

H2: individual criminal act or misconduct

H3: coordinated conduct by identified actors

H4: other explanation supported by a concrete observation

Evidence that would most strongly distinguish H1–H4

What finding would lower confidence in my preferred hypothesis?

Independent reviewer / review result

11 Retaliation chronology

This worksheet separates sequence from causation. Forum, worker coverage and protected-disclosure requirements differ. Check the relevant office and deadlines.[C06, C18, C22, C23] **Disclosure or protected activity / content / recipient / date**

Receipt and evidence the decision-maker knew

Personnel action / date / stated reason / decision-maker

Prior performance and comparable treatment records

Evidence connecting activity to action; evidence against connection

Other explanations / requested records

Applicable forum, deadline, counsel or independent advice

12 Health or exposure chronology

Record symptoms and circumstances without presuming a biological, chemical or directed-energy cause. Qualified clinicians and exposure specialists should interpret measurements. Do not collect hazardous material yourself.^[C09, C13, C15] **Symptoms: onset, duration, location and ordinary activities**

Contemporaneous clinical observations and test reports

Potential exposures actually observed / calibrated measurements

Medication, medical and environmental alternatives to assess

Who collected samples / methods / custody / laboratory controls

Clinical assessment, uncertainty and follow-up

Evidence needed for exposure, dose, mechanism and attribution

13 Existing-record request draft

Use the appropriate agency, state, court or private-record route. Federal FOIA concerns existing records and does not require an agency to conduct research to answer a theory.[C16, C17]

To: [verified records office]

I request copies of existing [record types] for [date range] concerning [specific event/file number], likely maintained by [custodian/system]. Please include [specific metadata, versions or attachments] where retained. My scope excludes [unnecessary personal information]. If parts are withheld, please identify the applicable basis and provide any reasonably segregable material. Please advise concerning fees before exceeding [amount]. Please send the tracking number and instructions for any applicable review or appeal.

[Name and safe contact channel appropriate to the request]

Request ID / date / delivery and receipt proof

Scope and custodian confirmed how?

Response, withholding grounds or no-records result

Clarification / appeal / deadline and authority

What the response changes in the claim register

14 Preservation request draft

This is a request template, not a claim that every recipient has a specific legal duty. Tailor any asserted duty or litigation hold with qualified advice.

Please preserve existing records relevant to [specific event/decision and date range], including [identified records], associated metadata, audit logs and retained versions. Please avoid routine deletion or overwriting of responsive material while the scope and appropriate process are clarified. This request does not ask you to create new evidence or disclose material through an unauthorized channel. Please identify a records contact and acknowledge receipt.

Recipient and basis for believing records are held there

Specific systems, records and dates

Known retention schedule or overwrite risk

Request, receipt, response and follow-up

15 Correction and downstream propagation

Correction ID / original assertion / version / publication locations

New evidence and source pinpoint

Corrected assertion and reason

Which timelines, maps, summaries and decisions relied on it?

Who must receive the correction and through what authorized route?

Date sent / receipt / downstream correction verified

Unresolved differences / next review

16 Public-release review

Release ID / version / reviewer / approval date

Each factual claim has a source and status?

Contrary evidence and uncertainty retained?

Private identities, children, addresses, health records and credentials removed?

Redactions irreversible in the released derivative and metadata inspected?

Authority, consent or lawful basis to publish each exhibit?

Classification, court restrictions and third-party rights checked?

Hashes, source register and correction route present?

Public repository contents reviewed separately from private folder?

17 Witness account for review

This is an unsigned narrative template. It is not a notarized affidavit or a jurisdiction-specific declaration. Do not add an oath, signature block or penalty-of-perjury language without choosing the correct legal form and reviewing the facts. **Name or protected identifier / relationship to events**

Facts personally known, in numbered paragraphs

Records used to refresh recollection, with exhibits

Statements learned from others, identified separately

Limitations, approximations and corrections

Safe contact through authorized reviewer

Legal form / competent reviewer / signature process to determine

Source register

References

- [C03] Kent, Chevalier, Grance and Dang; NIST. *Guide to Integrating Forensic Techniques into Incident Response, NIST SP 800-86*. 2006-08. <https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/86/final> **Type:** technical guidance. **Pinpoint:** Abstract; sections 3 and 4 **Scope:** Computer and network forensic process and data sources. **Limit:** IT guidance, not a complete law-enforcement manual or legal advice; older implementation examples.
- [C06] U.S. Office of Special Counsel. *Prohibited Personnel Practices Overview*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.osc.gov/services/prohibited-personnel-practices/overview/> **Type:** official legal guidance. **Pinpoint:** Whistleblower Retaliation; Other Retaliation; Accessing Medical Records **Scope:** Personnel retaliation elements and examples for covered federal employment. **Limit:** Coverage and remedies depend on employee status, disclosure and forum; examples are not case findings.
- [C07] Office of the Director of National Intelligence. *Accountability: Inspector General of the Intelligence Community*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.odni.gov/accountability/> **Type:** official reporting guidance. **Pinpoint:** IC IG; How to report to the IC IG **Scope:** Current IC IG hotline route for intelligence-related wrongdoing and reprisal. **Limit:** Anyone may report, but some protections apply only to IC employees/contractors; confidentiality is not guaranteed anonymity.
- [C08] National Archives and Records Administration. *Unauthorized Dispositions*. 2017-12-08; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.archives.gov/records-mgmt/resources/unauthorized-dispositions> **Type:** official records guidance. **Pinpoint:** 44 USC 3106; 36 CFR Part 1230; reporting paragraph **Scope:** Unlawful or accidental removal, alteration and destruction of federal records. **Limit:** Federal-records jurisdiction; records loss alone does not establish intent.
- [C09] OSHA. *29 CFR 1910.1450: Occupational Exposure to Hazardous Chemicals in Laboratories*. current web text accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.osha.gov/laws-regs/regulations/standardnumber/1910/1910.1450> **Type:** regulation. **Pinpoint:** Paragraphs (d), (e), (f), (g), (h) **Scope:** Chemical hygiene plans, exposure monitoring, medical consultation and safety data sheets. **Limit:** Application depends on workplace and substance; no individual exposure or causation finding.
- [C10] U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. *Your Medical Records*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.hhs.gov/hipaa/for-individuals/medical-records/index.html> **Type:** official patient-rights guidance. **Pinpoint:** Access; Corrections; limitations notice **Scope:** Access to covered medical/billing records and amendment or disagreement procedures. **Limit:** Exceptions apply; psychotherapy notes are separately restricted; guidance includes Ciox court-order qualification.
- [C13] CDC National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health. *Request a NIOSH Health Hazard Evaluation*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/hhe/request/index.html> **Type:** official occupational-health service. **Pinpoint:** At a glance; steps to take **Scope:** Employee, employer or union request for workplace hazard evaluation. **Limit:** Workplace evaluation channel, not an emergency service or attribution of an intentional attack.
- [C15] CDC and NIH. *Biosafety in Microbiological and Biomedical Laboratories, sixth edition*. 2020; current landing page accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.cdc.gov/labs/bmbl/index.html> **Type:** official biosafety guidance. **Pinpoint:** Core principle: protocol-driven risk assessment **Scope:** Laboratory risk assessment and appropriate safeguards. **Limit:** Advisory guidance cannot identify every risk or establish deliberate exposure.
- [C16] U.S. Department of Justice, Office of Information Policy. *Make a FOIA Request to DOJ*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.justice.gov/oip/make-foia-request-doj> **Type:** official records-request guidance. **Pinpoint:** Component routing paragraphs **Scope:** DOJ components process their own records requests. **Limit:** Response timing and releasability depend on records, exemptions and workload.
- [C17] FOIA.gov / U.S. Department of Justice. *Freedom of Information Act: Frequently Asked Questions*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.foia.gov/faq.html> **Type:** official records-request guidance. **Pinpoint:** What can I ask for; who handles requests **Scope:** Requests concern existing agency records; agencies need not conduct new research or answer questions. **Limit:** Federal FOIA differs from state public-records law and court access procedures.

- [C18] Department of Defense Office of Inspector General. *Whistleblower Reprisal Investigations*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.dodig.mil/Components/Administrative-Investigations/Whistleblower-Reprisal-Investigations/> **Type:** official reporting guidance. **Pinpoint:** Directorate overview **Scope:** DoD whistleblower reprisal investigation entry point. **Limit:** Search-index overview verified; direct retrieval returned HTTP 403. Confirm current eligibility and procedures at filing.
- [C19] Inspector General of the Intelligence Community. *IC Whistleblower Protection Act Disclosure Form*. Revision January 2024. https://archive.dni.gov/files/ICIG/Documents/Hotline/Forms/ICWPA_Disclosure_Form_v7.pdf **Type:** official intake form. **Pinpoint:** Pages 1-2 and 4-5 **Scope:** ICWPA urgent-concern criteria; classified-submission coordination; confidentiality exceptions. **Limit:** Archived form: use current IC IG entry point to confirm submission instructions.
- [C20] McCallister, Grance and Scarfone; NIST. *Guide to Protecting the Confidentiality of Personally Identifiable Information, NIST SP 800-122*. 2010-04. <https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/122/final> **Type:** technical guidance. **Pinpoint:** Abstract and scope **Scope:** Context-based protection from inappropriate access, use and disclosure of personal information. **Limit:** Older guidance; privacy risk remains contextual and cannot be eliminated by labels alone.
- [C22] U.S. Office of Special Counsel. *Disclosure of Wrongdoing Overview*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.osc.gov/services/disclosure-of-wrongdoing/overview/> **Type:** official reporting guidance. **Pinpoint:** Disclosure Unit process **Scope:** Covered federal employee/applicant disclosures; agency investigation and OSC oversight. **Limit:** Wrongdoing disclosure process differs from retaliation complaint; OSC states it lacks independent investigative authority in these disclosure cases.
- [C23] OSHA Whistleblower Protection Program. *How to File a Whistleblower Complaint*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. https://www.whistleblowers.gov/complaint_page **Type:** official reporting guidance. **Pinpoint:** Time Limits for Filing a Complaint **Scope:** OSHA-administered retaliation statutes and filing options. **Limit:** Jurisdiction and deadlines vary; listed time limits include 30, 60, 90 and 180 days.
- [C24] Department of Defense Office of Inspector General. *DoD Hotline: Classified Complaints*. n.d.; accessed 2026-10-01. <https://www.dodig.mil/Components/Administrative-Investigations/DoD-Hotline/Classified-Complaint/> **Type:** official reporting guidance. **Pinpoint:** Coordination of classified submissions **Scope:** Contact the Hotline to arrange appropriate classified submission procedures. **Limit:** Search-index summary verified; do not send classified content through ordinary web forms or unsecured calls.